endpoint (`/`).

Listing 2.3 Defining an HTTP endpoint to return a welcome message

```
package com.polarbookshop.catalogservice;

import org.springframework.web.bind.annotation.GetMapping;
import org.springframework.web.bind.annotation.RestController;

@RestController                    ❶
public class HomeController {

  @GetMapping("/")                 ❷
  public String getGreeting() {
    return "Welcome to the book catalog!";
  }
}
```

❶ Identifies a class defining handlers for REST/HTTP endpoints

❷ Handles GET requests to the root endpoint

The `@RestController` annotation identifies a class as a controller handling incoming HTTP requests. Using the `@GetMapping` annotation, you can mark the `getGreeting()` method as a handler for `GET` requests arriving at the root endpoint (`/`). Any `GET` request to that endpoint will be processed by this method. In the next chapter, I'll cover how to build RESTful services with Spring in more detail.

TESTING THE APPLICATION

A basic test setup is included when you create a Spring project from Spring Initializr. In the build.gradle file you automatically get the dependencies needed for testing a Spring application. Furthermore, a test class is automatically generated. Let's look at what the `CatalogServiceApplicationTests` class might look like after you initialize the project.